

[FINDINGS]

docs/story.md

THE QUESTION

What turns a new EVE character into a player who stays?

Belonging.

New players who join a player corporation, get a kill or fight in a big battle in their first month stay about twice as often, and pay more often. Dying hardly matters: 88% lose a ship.

STILL ACTIVE 3 MONTHS AFTER THEIR FIRST MONTH

No corp, no kill

9.1%

All new players

14.9%

Corporation of 201–1,000

22.8%

Joined a corp and got a kill

24.2%

Fought in a battle of 100+ pilots

27.5%

2.73M → 13%

Characters created (exact), and the share who ever fight or trade with other players.

8.2%

Still active after 12 months. World of Warcraft at its peak, measured the same way: also 8.2%.

≥ 1.4×

Corporation effect on contracts only, a measure fleet killmails can't inflate. The 2–3× gaps are the upper end.

35% vs 14%

Fly a paid (Omega-only) ship within 12 months: joined a corp and got a kill, vs neither.

23,311

Lapsed players back in the Catalyst month (Nov 2025). Expansions win back old players; their new signups don't stay longer.

+11%

CCP subscription and in-game revenue in 2025 (\$55.0M → \$60.8M), while signups fell 10%.

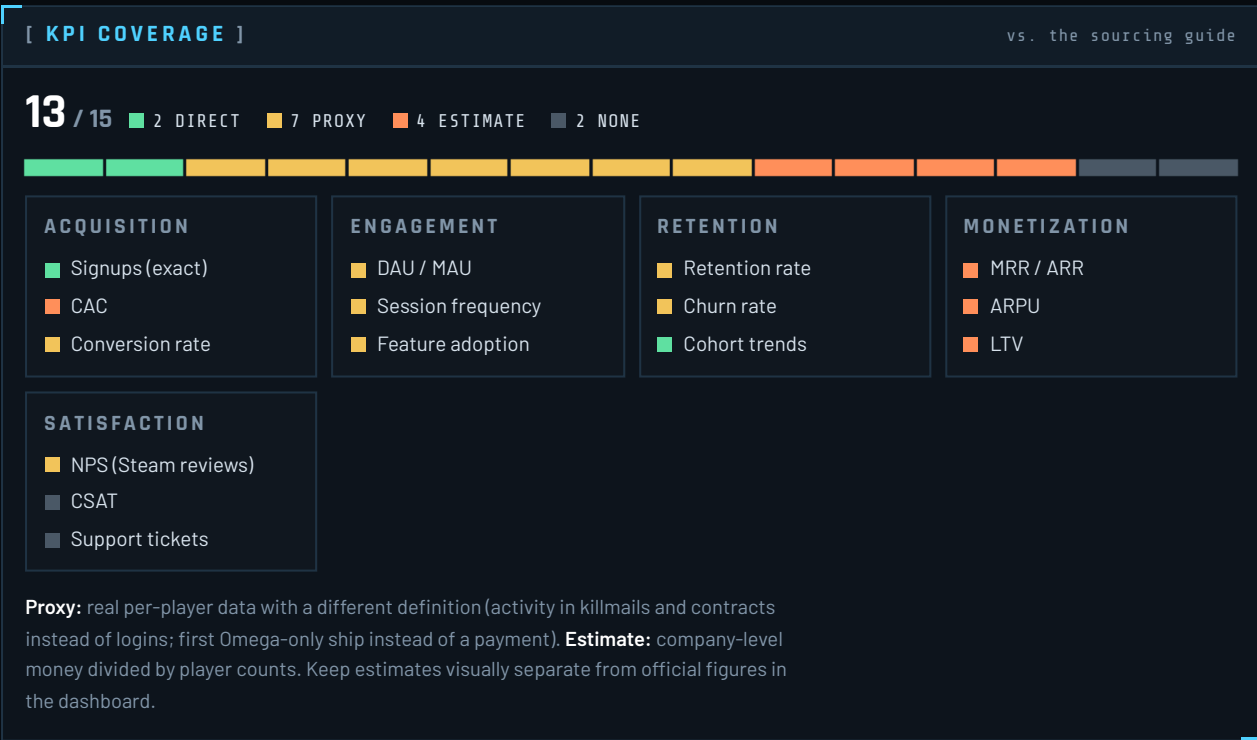
[DATA SOURCES]

all real · all public

SOURCE AND WHAT IT IS	PUBLISHER	ONE ROW IS	VOLUME
Killmails Record CCP creates whenever a ship is destroyed, shared publicly by players on zKillboard.	zKillboard / CCP, via EVE Ref	one ship destroyed, with victim and attackers	15.8M kills
Public contracts Item exchanges, auctions and courier jobs players post publicly.	CCP, via EVE Ref	one contract, with its items	4.7M
Characters and signups Public character profiles, plus CCP's ID sequence, which gives the exact number of characters created each month.	eve-kill.com, CCP API	one character; one month of signups	889,560 · 32 months
Static game data CCP's database of ships, items and map, used to spot Omega-only (paid) ships.	CCP SDE	one ship, item or solar system	267 Omega ships
Market and economy Daily PLEX and store-item trading, and CCP's Monthly Economic Reports.	CCP, via EVE Ref	one item, region and day; one indicator and day	974 days · 33 reports

SOURCE AND WHAT IT IS	PUBLISHER	ONE ROW IS	VOLUME
Players online and wars Concurrent players, wars and sovereignty fights.	EVE Offline, CCP API	one day; one war or campaign	daily
Interest Steam player counts, Twitch viewing, Google Trends.	SteamCharts, SullyGnome, Google	one month or week of a metric	monthly
Sentiment Steam reviews and official forum threads on pricing, new players and ownership.	Valve, CCP forums	one review; one post (authors hashed)	39,555 · 13,629
Pricing, news and events Archived Omega and store pages, CCP news, patch history and lore events.	CCP, Wayback Machine	a price snapshot, article or event	68 prices · 15 plans
Financials Pearl Abyss quarterly reports (owner until May 2026) and CCP's audited annual accounts. They agree within 0.5%.	Pearl Abyss IR, Skatturinn	one quarter or fiscal year	87 figures
Benchmarks World of Warcraft player activity (2006–07), measured with our retention method, plus industry figures.	WoWAH dataset, published reports	one metric	10

Field detail: [docs/raw_inventory.md](#). ERD and normalization: [docs/erd_design.md](#).
 Dashboard CSVs, ready for Tableau Public: [data/exports/](#).



- [CAVEATS]
- ♦ **We see 13% of new characters per player:** those who fight or trade. Signups, players online and revenue cover everyone. Solo miners and market traders stay invisible. This is our ERD boundary.
 - ♦ **Activity is measured by visibility.** A player who stops fighting looks like they quit. The contracts-only check bounds this.
 - ♦ **Correlation, not causation.** Players who join corporations may be more committed to begin with.
 - ♦ **Characters, not accounts.** One account can hold several characters.
 - ♦ **No per-player payments exist publicly.** Paying is inferred from flying an Omega-only ship.
 - ♦ **Pearl Abyss sold CCP to its management on 6 May 2026.** CCP is now Fenris Creations; Pearl Abyss's EVE revenue ends at 4Q25.
 - ♦ **2026-07-13 has no killmails.** The file is missing at the source.